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Cardiff's Sophia Gardens **(in pic)**, the County Ground in Derby, and Loughborough University have been confirmed as host venues for the warm-up fixtures ahead of the 2026 ICC Women's T20 World Cup, which begins in Birmingham on June 12. While the full schedule is yet to be announced, the three venues will stage matches in the lead-up to the 10th edition of the tournament, set to be hosted in England and Wales.



SPORTSPICS

3

MI New York clinched its second Major League Cricket title with a thrilling five-run win over defending champion Washington Freedom in Dallas. With 12 needed off the final over, seamer Rushil Ugarkar held his nerve, conceding just six runs and dismissing Australia's Glenn Maxwell. While Washington had topped the group stage, New York — which finished fourth — stormed through the playoffs with back-to-back wins to lift the trophy.



ICRICKET ITALY

4

Italy and the Netherlands have qualified for the ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026 in India and Sri Lanka, with Italy making its debut at a senior ICC World Cup. Despite a nine-wicket loss to the Netherlands in The Hague, Italy edged past Jersey on net run rate after both teams finished with five points. Jersey had stunned Scotland with a last-ball, one-wicket win, knocking the Scots out of T20 World Cup contention for the first time in four editions.



AFP

5

South Africa's Wiaan Mulder revealed that Brian Lara encouraged him to break his Test record of 400 during a conversation after the recent match against Zimbabwe in Bulawayo, where Mulder had declared on 367 not out. "He said records are there to be broken and he wishes if I'm ever in that position again, I actually go and score more than what he had," Mulder shared. Still, he defended his decision to declare: "Respecting the game is the most important part for me."